

D706

Early Clinical in Elementary Education

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

Method © 2026 Erik Daniel Lindquist — Course Mastery Coach, armored drill. Items drafted with AI assistance under his direction.

How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

In a second-grade room with a colorful reading rug, the transition from recess to reading takes 12 minutes every day and is noisy. The rules chart is posted by the door. The class has a new student from another district. What should the candidate suggest to the mentor?

- A. Wait for the new student to adjust.
- B. Take away recess until the class is quiet.
- C. Point to the posted rules each day.
- D. Model the transition step by step, have students practice it, and reinforce it until it is quick.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2.

A candidate notices her mentor, who is a district teacher of the year, asks ten questions in a math lesson and the same four students answer every time. The class has 24 students and a new set of math manipulatives. What change would raise engagement most?

- A. Ask more questions to volunteers.
- B. Have every student write answers on whiteboards and hold them up.
- C. Call on the highest-achieving students to model.
- D. Use the new manipulatives, since hands-on work always engages everyone.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A class has 24 students. The teacher asks 10 questions. How many student responses happen if each is answered by one volunteer, versus if everyone answers on whiteboards?

- A. 240 vs. 10
- B. 10 vs. 34
- C. 10 vs. 240
- D. 24 vs. 240

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

A candidate teaching her first science lesson in a classroom with a class hamster asks, “Why do you think the ice melted faster in the sun?” After one second of silence, she answers it herself. Her university supervisor was not present. What should she change?

- A. Wait at least 3 seconds before calling on anyone or rephrasing.
- B. Ask an easier yes/no question instead.
- C. Call on the first student to raise a hand.
- D. Answer her own questions only when the supervisor is absent.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

A fourth-grade candidate, planning a lesson on the class’s favorite novel, asks: “Which character changed more by the end of the story? Use evidence from two chapters to support your answer.” The novel has 160 pages. What DOK level is the question?

- A. DOK 3
- B. DOK 4, because the book is long
- C. DOK 2
- D. DOK 1

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A teacher wants a DOK 1 question about the water cycle. Which fits?

- A. “Describe” questions are always DOK 1.
- B. “Explain how temperature affects evaporation.”
- C. “What is the name for water vapor turning into liquid?”
- D. “Design an investigation to test what speeds evaporation.”

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A mentor who keeps a lemon-scented diffuser running is reading with a small group when two students at a far table start tossing an eraser. Without leaving the group, she makes eye contact, says their names calmly, and keeps the reading going. The class has 26 students. Which teacher skill is this?

- A. Ignoring misbehavior
- B. Withitness and overlapping
- C. Wait time
- D. Gradual release

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

Before independent practice on adding fractions, a candidate who just returned from a conference asks, “Does everyone understand? Any questions?” The room is silent, and many students nod. The lesson is on a Friday. What is the problem?

- A. Friday lessons should skip checking.
- B. Nods and silence give no evidence; she should have every student solve one problem and show it.
- C. She should ask the same question again louder.
- D. There is no problem, since nobody had questions.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

On exit tickets, 18 of 25 students solve a problem correctly. What percentage showed understanding, and what does that suggest?

- A. 28%; reteach the whole class.
- B. 18%; reteach the whole class.
- C. 72%; reteach or regroup the 7 students who missed it before moving on.
- D. 72%; the whole class is ready to move on.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

A candidate, whose placement is in a school with a large garden, models how to write a topic sentence, then immediately assigns students to write paragraphs alone. Most struggle. She is observed by her mentor weekly. What step did she skip?

- A.** Guided practice (“we do”)
- B.** Modeling (“I do”)
- C.** A longer model
- D.** Independent practice (“you do”)

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ____	☐ sure ☐ unsure ☐ guess
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11.

Midway through a lesson in a room with new standing desks, a candidate sees that most students are drawing the wrong kind of graph. She stops, shows a quick example, and has pairs fix their work. Her mentor has a master’s degree. Which kind of reflection did she use?

- A.** Summative assessment
- B.** Reflection-on-action
- C.** Not reflection, because it was not written down
- D.** Reflection-in-action

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ____	☐ sure ☐ unsure ☐ guess
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12. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

After school, a candidate sorts the day’s exit tickets, sees a common error, and plans a new warm-up for tomorrow. Which kind of reflection is this?

- A.** Reflection-in-action
- B.** Withitness
- C.** Pre-assessment
- D.** Reflection-on-action

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ____	☐ sure ☐ unsure ☐ guess
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STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer D Concept 1

In a second-grade room ~~with a colorful reading rug~~, the transition from recess to reading takes 12 minutes every day and is noisy. The rules chart is posted by the door. ~~The class has a new student from another district.~~ What should the candidate suggest to the mentor?

Target word: best fix **Decides:** Procedures must be taught, modeled, and practiced.

A	Camouflage	The new student is not the cause of a daily class-wide problem.
B	Adjacent category	A punishment, not a taught procedure.
C	Dropped element	Drops the modeling and practice.
D	Correct	Explicit teaching and practice make procedures stick.

2. Answer B Concept 2

A candidate notices her mentor, ~~who is a district teacher of the year~~, asks ten questions in a math lesson and the same four students answer every time. The class has 24 students and ~~a new set of math manipulatives~~. What change would raise engagement most?

Target word: best change **Decides:** Every-pupil response.

A	Dropped element	Still only volunteers respond.
B	Correct	Every student responds and the teacher sees all answers.
C	Inverted operation	Narrows participation further.
D	Absolute language	Manipulatives help but do not guarantee everyone responds.

3. Answer C Concept 2 · transfer

A class has 24 students. The teacher asks 10 questions. How many student responses happen if each is answered by one volunteer, versus if everyone answers on whiteboards?

Target word: compute responses **Decides:** 10×1 vs. 10×24 .

A	Confusion set	Swaps the two cases.
B	Inverted operation	Adds instead of multiplying.
C	Correct	One per question vs. 24 per question.
D	Wrong stem number	Uses class size for the volunteer case.

4. Answer A Concept 3

A candidate teaching her first science lesson ~~in a classroom with a class hamster~~ asks, "Why do you think the ice melted faster in the sun?" After one second of silence, she answers it herself. ~~Her university supervisor was not present.~~ What should she change?

Target word: what to change **Decides:** Too little wait time.

A	Correct	More wait time gives students time to think and improves answers.
B	Adjacent category	Lowers the thinking instead of allowing time for it.
C	Inverted operation	Keeps wait time short.
D	Camouflage	Who is watching does not change good practice.

5. Answer A Concept 4

A fourth-grade candidate, planning a lesson ~~on the class's favorite novel~~, asks: "Which character changed more by the end of the story? Use evidence from two chapters to support your answer." ~~The novel has 160 pages.~~ What DOK level is the question?

Target word: DOK level **Decides:** Reasoning and a claim supported with text evidence.

A	Correct	Strategic thinking: making and supporting a claim with evidence.
B	Camouflage	DOK 4 means extended work across time and sources, not a long book.
C	Adjacent category	Comparing traits alone is DOK 2; supporting a judgment with evidence raises it.
D	Inverted operation	Recall would be naming a character or event.

6. Answer C Concept 4 • transfer

A teacher wants a DOK 1 question about the water cycle. Which fits?

Target word: pick the recall question **Decides:** DOK 1 is recall.

A	Absolute language	Verbs alone do not set DOK.
B	Adjacent category	Explaining a relationship is DOK 2.
C	Correct	Recall of a term.
D	Inverted operation	Planning an investigation is DOK 3.

7. Answer B Concept 5

A mentor ~~who keeps a lemon-scented diffuser running~~ is reading with a small group when two students at a far table start tossing an eraser. Without leaving the group, she makes eye contact, says their names calmly, and keeps the reading going. ~~The class has 26 students.~~ Which teacher skill is this?

Target word: name the skill **Decides:** Handling two things at once while aware of the room.

A	Inverted operation	She addressed it, just without stopping the lesson.
B	Correct	She noticed early and handled it while continuing the group.
C	Confusion set	Wait time is pausing after questions.
D	Adjacent category	An instructional sequence, not a management skill.

8. Answer B Concept 6

Before independent practice on adding fractions, a candidate ~~who just returned from a conference~~ asks, "Does everyone understand? Any questions?" The room is silent, and many students nod. ~~The lesson is on a Friday.~~ What is the problem?

Target word: problem with the check **Decides:** Silence and nods give no evidence of understanding.

A	Camouflage	The day does not decide the practice.
B	Correct	A visible response from everyone gives usable data.
C	Dropped element	Repeats a check that gives no data.
D	Inverted operation	Treats silence as understanding.

9. Answer C Concept 6 · transfer

On exit tickets, 18 of 25 students solve a problem correctly. What percentage showed understanding, and what does that suggest?

Target word: compute and interpret **Decides:** $18 \div 25 = 72\%$.

A	Inverted operation	28% is the share who missed it.
B	Wrong stem number	Uses the count as a percent.
C	Correct	Data shows most but not all understood.
D	Dropped element	Drops the 7 students who need support.

10. Answer A Concept 7

A candidate, ~~whose placement is in a school with a large garden~~, models how to write a topic sentence, then immediately assigns students to write paragraphs alone. Most struggle. ~~She is observed by her mentor weekly.~~ What step did she skip?

Target word: missing step **Decides:** Guided practice between modeling and independent work.

A	Correct	Students need supported practice before working alone.
B	Dropped element	She did model; that is not the missing step.
C	Adjacent category	More modeling does not replace supported practice.
D	Inverted operation	She gave that; it came too soon.

11. Answer D Concept 8

Midway through a lesson ~~in a room with new standing desks~~, a candidate sees that most students are drawing the wrong kind of graph. She stops, shows a quick example, and has pairs fix their work. ~~Her mentor has a master's degree.~~ Which kind of reflection did she use?

Target word: name the reflection **Decides:** Adjusting during the lesson.

A	Adjacent category	Summative evaluates at the end, not adjusting mid-lesson.
B	Confusion set	That happens after the lesson.
C	Absolute language	Reflection can happen in the moment.
D	Correct	She adjusted while teaching.

12. Answer D Concept 8 · transfer

After school, a candidate sorts the day's exit tickets, sees a common error, and plans a new warm-up for tomorrow. Which kind of reflection is this?

Target word: name the reflection — the reverse timing **Decides:** Analysis after the lesson to plan ahead.

A	Inverted operation	That happens during the lesson.
B	Confusion set	A classroom management skill, not reflection.
C	Adjacent category	Pre-assessment happens before a unit to gauge prior knowledge.
D	Correct	Looking back after teaching to plan the next lesson.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	5	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	2	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	8	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	10	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	3	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	4	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	4	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Teaching routines and procedures	Effective elementary teachers explicitly teach, model, practice, and reinforce procedures (lining up, transitions, getting help) early and revisit them when they slip.	Posting rules once and expecting children to follow procedures.	A recurring daily activity that goes badly.
2	Opportunities to respond	Every-pupil responses (whiteboards, choral response, turn-and-talk, signals) raise engagement and give the teacher data on everyone, unlike calling on one volunteer.	Judging engagement by how many hands go up.	Questions answered by the same few students.
3	Wait time	Pausing 3 or more seconds after a question (and after a student answers) increases the length, quality, and number of responses.	Answering your own question or calling on the first hand.	A silence right after a question.
4	Depth of Knowledge levels	DOK 1 recall, DOK 2 skill/concept (classify, compare, explain relationships), DOK 3 strategic thinking (reasoning with evidence), DOK 4 extended thinking over time across sources.	Rating a question by its verb or its difficulty instead of the thinking required.	A question to classify by cognitive demand.
5	Withitness and overlapping	Kounin found effective managers show withitness (awareness of the whole room, caught early) and overlapping (handling two things at once) while keeping lesson momentum.	Stopping the whole lesson to deal with one student.	A teacher working with a small group while others drift.
6	Checking for understanding	Ask every student to show understanding in a way you can see (whiteboards, exit tickets, signals) during the lesson; “Any questions?” or “Does everyone get it?” gives no usable data.	Taking silence or nods as understanding.	What the teacher does before releasing students to practice.
7	Gradual release of responsibility	Move from teacher modeling (I do) to guided practice (we do) to collaborative or independent practice (you do), with checks between stages.	Jumping from demonstration straight to independent work.	A lesson where students fail on independent practice.
8	Reflection-in-action vs. reflection-on-action	Reflection-in-action is adjusting during the lesson in response to students; reflection-on-action is analyzing afterward to plan.	Thinking reflection only happens after the lesson.	When the adjustment happens.

Course scope (public description): Early Clinical Experiences is a pivotal course designed to bridge the gap between theoretical knowledge and practical teaching skills. This course offers aspiring educators an immersive experience in real classroom settings under the mentorship of experienced teachers. Candidates engage in a range of activities, including observation, to develop a deeper understanding of classroom dynamics, student engagement, and effective instructional strategies. Emphasizing reflective practice, the course encourages participants to analyze their experiences, integrate feedback, and adapt their teaching methods accordingly. This experiential learning approach equips future teachers with the confidence and competence necessary to foster a positive and impactful learning environment for their students.